

Statusfied

Facebook has increased the maximum length of its status update to 63,206 characters, more than 12x its previous length

Google+ finds your face

Similar to a Facebook's auto-tagging feature, it's called Find My Face

Predictions from VIA

VIA Technologies is the foremost fabless supplier of power-efficient x86 processor platforms, and an important driving force in today's PC, thin client, ultra mobile, motherboard, and embedded markets. The company is also known for its digital media chipsets, and is a leading supplier of telecommunications hardware

Digit recently caught up with Richard Brown, Vice President of International Marketing at VIA Technologies, and discussed the latest in the tablet processor and SoC (System-on-Chip) market, and the company's role in the future of the fast growing segment in India:

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d What is VIA's strategy in the global SoC market?

Our strategy is to provide a turnkey solution, including everything from the SoC to the hardware reference design, firmware, and software to our customers rather than just a chip. This not only helps reduce customer development costs but also enables them to bring their products to market very quickly. On the product side, our focus is on developing low power yet high performance SoC platforms with highly integrated connectivity and multimedia feature sets that meet the specific needs of our key target segments such as tablets.

d What, according to VIA, is the future of the low-cost tablet market?

The potential for low cost tablets is huge not just in India but also globally. Indeed, this year we estimate that well over ten million tablets have been shipped worldwide by Chinese white box tablet manufacturers, which makes it the second largest segment in the market after the iPad, and we expect the volumes to continue to grow dramatically in 2012.

d What does VIA think of India's tablet market potential?

The potential for tablets in India is huge. You just have to look at the growth in the country's mobile phone market over the past five years to see the possibilities. For millions of people, tablets will provide the first affordable large screen device that allows them to experience the Internet. For companies, the tablet provides a low cost means of digitizing their sales and



Richard Brown, Vice President,
International Marketing, VIA Technologies

other operations and allowing employees to access the data and applications on their corporate cloud from almost anywhere in the country. As for education, India is showing the whole world the potential for tablets in universities, colleges, and schools with its Aakash project. The possibilities are extremely exciting.

d How is VIA working with various partners in India to enable local manufacturing?

Establishing manufacturing facilities in India is extremely important to ensure stronger support for our tablet customers and also over the longer term foster localized innovation to meet the specific needs of the market. Currently we are working with a number of partners who are setting up manufacturing facilities in India and will be making more announcements about the specifics early in the new year.

d Does VIA intend to work on other

segments of the tablet market, other than low-cost?

We have an extremely aggressive roadmap for improving the performance, power consumption, and functionality of our SoC platforms in the future and as we implement this we will be able to address different segments in the market. There are a lot of exciting opportunities for innovation around the tablet form factor.

d What is your most popular SoC platform used in tablets currently?

For tablets our most popular SOC platform is the VIA WM8650. This features a high-performance, low power ARM core with excellent multimedia capabilities.

d Which tablets currently run on VIA technology? Which of these are available in the Indian market?

There are over thirty manufacturers producing tablets based on the VIA WM8650 in a variety of 7" and 8" screen form factors. 10" models will be available early next year. There are a lot of companies in India selling VIA WM8650 tablets in the market including Simmtronics and Wishtel as well as a lot of smaller brands. It is difficult to get an accurate picture of the India tablet market because it is growing so fast, but we would estimate that we have the largest share of it.

d What is VIA's role in the current mobile market?

VIA Telecom is the second largest supplier of CDMA phones in the global market, and its chips are used by some of the world's leading mobile phone brand names. Many of the CDMA phones sold in India are based on VIA Telecom chips. **d**